

# RUH Airport Status

DISRUPTED

As of 2:51 PM, Saturday 10 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

158 flights cancelled today · last takeoff 1:39 PM · last landing 2:05 PM

Airport halted since 2:05 PM, 45+ minutes with no takeoff or landing. Last takeoff XY277 at 1:39 PM; last landing SM461 at 2:05 PM. Morning halt 6:37–8:08 AM still unexplained. Cancellations remain elevated.

HEADLINE

Airport halted since 2:05 PM; no takeoff or landing for 45+ minutes; 158 flights cancelled today so far.

There were 0 takeoffs in the last hour, the latest XY277 to Sharm el-Sheikh at 1:39 PM. The latest landing was SM461 from Cairo at 2:05 PM, with 5 landings in the last hour. 158 flights are cancelled today (77 departures, 81 arrivals) and 3 arrivals have diverted. **Yesterday, 9 October:** 166 of 703 flights cancelled, 18 arrivals diverted and four halts of 45+ minutes, the longest 7:41 to 9:38 PM (no landing until 9:45 PM). No official reason has been given for the evening stop. **This morning:** a 91-minute halt ran from 6:37 to 8:08 AM with no takeoff or landing. **This afternoon:** the board shows another stop since 2:05 PM — no takeoff or landing for 45+ minutes as of this check (last takeoff flynas XY277 at 1:39 PM; last landing Air Cairo SM461 at 2:05 PM). No official explanation. Air Arabia has suspended Sharjah–Riyadh through Sunday; SriLankan Airlines remains suspended to Riyadh until 18 October; Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia are still cutting UAE–Riyadh on Saturday. Board cancellations remain elevated.

|                                                    |                                                  |                                          |                              |                                |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 158<br>FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY                     | 1:39 PM<br>LAST TAKEOFF                          | 2:05 PM<br>LAST LANDING                  | 0<br>TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR     | 3<br>ARRIVALS DIVERTED         |
| 77 departures + 81 arrivals, 21% of 769 scheduled. | XY277 to Sharm el-Sheikh, 72 min before 2:51 PM. | SM461 from Cairo, 46 min before 2:51 PM. | 5 landings in the last hour. | Mostly to Qassim, Dammam, MAA. |

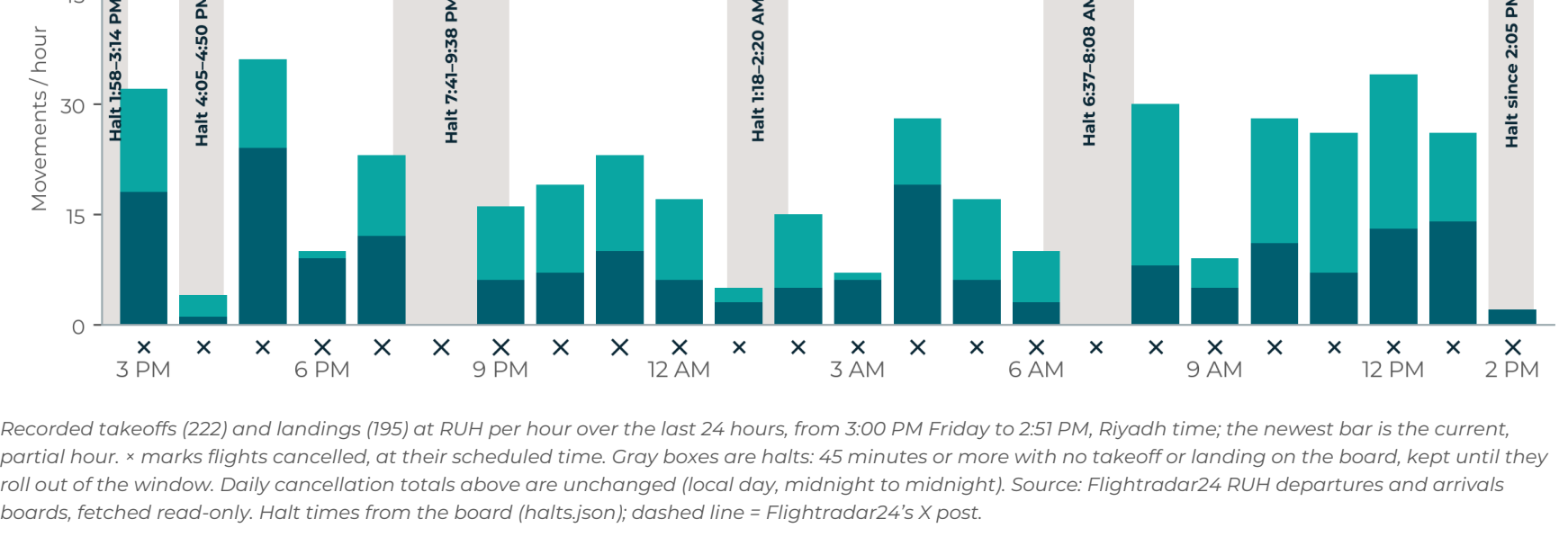
**Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:51 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 158 (77 departures, 20%; 81 arrivals, 21%) at 2:52 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

| MEASURE                                     | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS   | TOTAL      | BASIS                  |
|---------------------------------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------------------|
| Cancelled today                             | 77 (20%)   | 81 (21%)   | 158        | FR24 stats panel       |
| Cancelled today, board count                | 77         | 81         | 158        | FR24 boards, local day |
| Delayed today                               | 136 (35%)  | 93 (24%)   | 229        | FR24 stats panel       |
| On time today (share of operated)           | 30 (18%)   | 21 (18%)   | 51         | FR24 stats panel       |
| Average delay, recent flights               | 18 min     | 70 min     | —          | FR24 stats panel       |
| Disruption index (0–5)                      | 2.68       | 5          | —          | FR24 stats panel       |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 146 of 235 | 108 of 195 | 254 of 430 | FR24 boards            |
| Diverted today                              | —          | 3          | 3          | FR24 arrivals board    |
| Already cancelled tomorrow                  | 14         | 26         | 40         | FR24 stats panel       |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale)             | 75         | 96         | 171        | FR24 stats panel       |

| CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5 | MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5 |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Saudia 65                       | Jeddah 24                    |
| flyadeal 17                     | Dubai 16                     |
| Qatar Airways 8                 | Dammam 12                    |
| Turkish Airlines 7              | Istanbul 11                  |
| IndiGo 6                        | Doha 8                       |

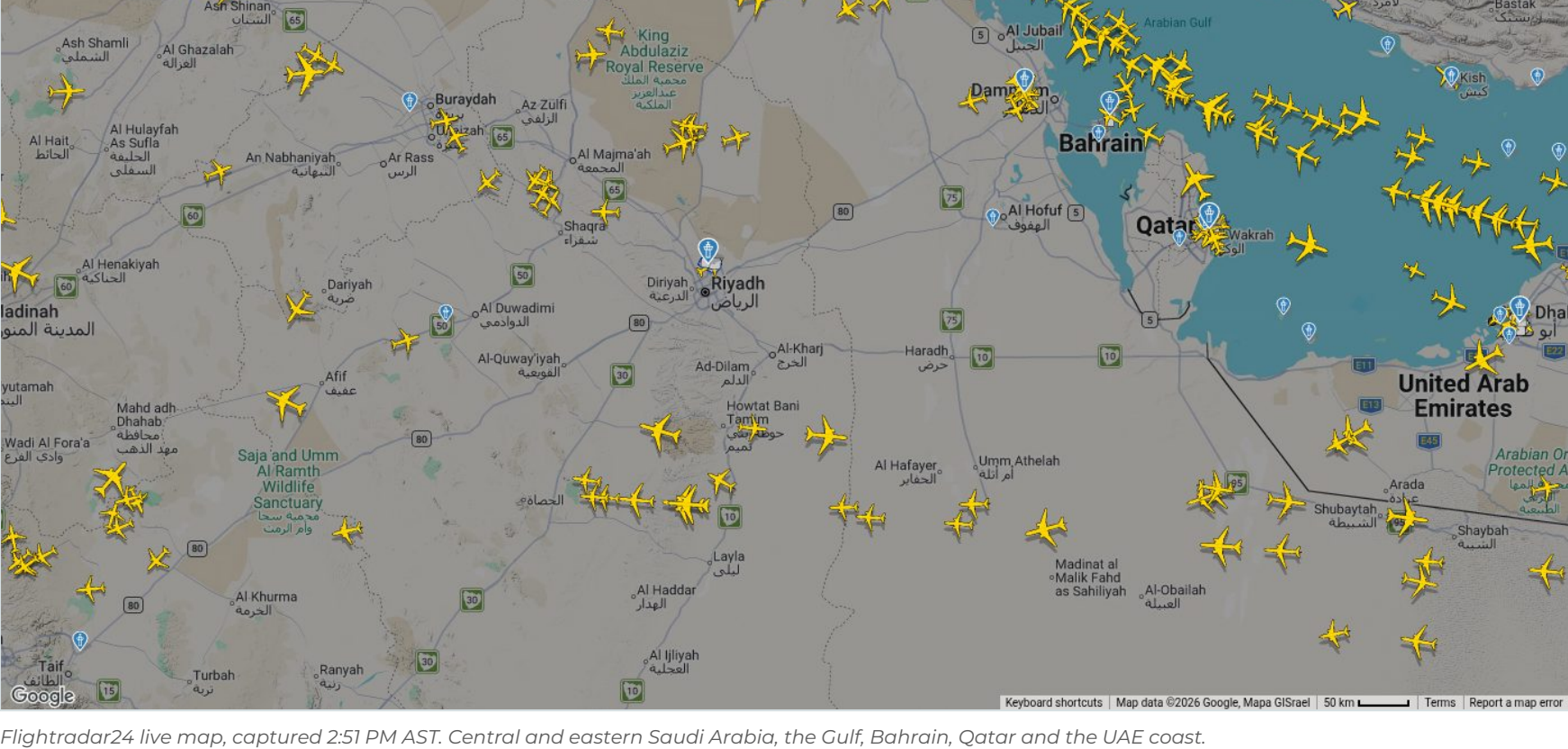
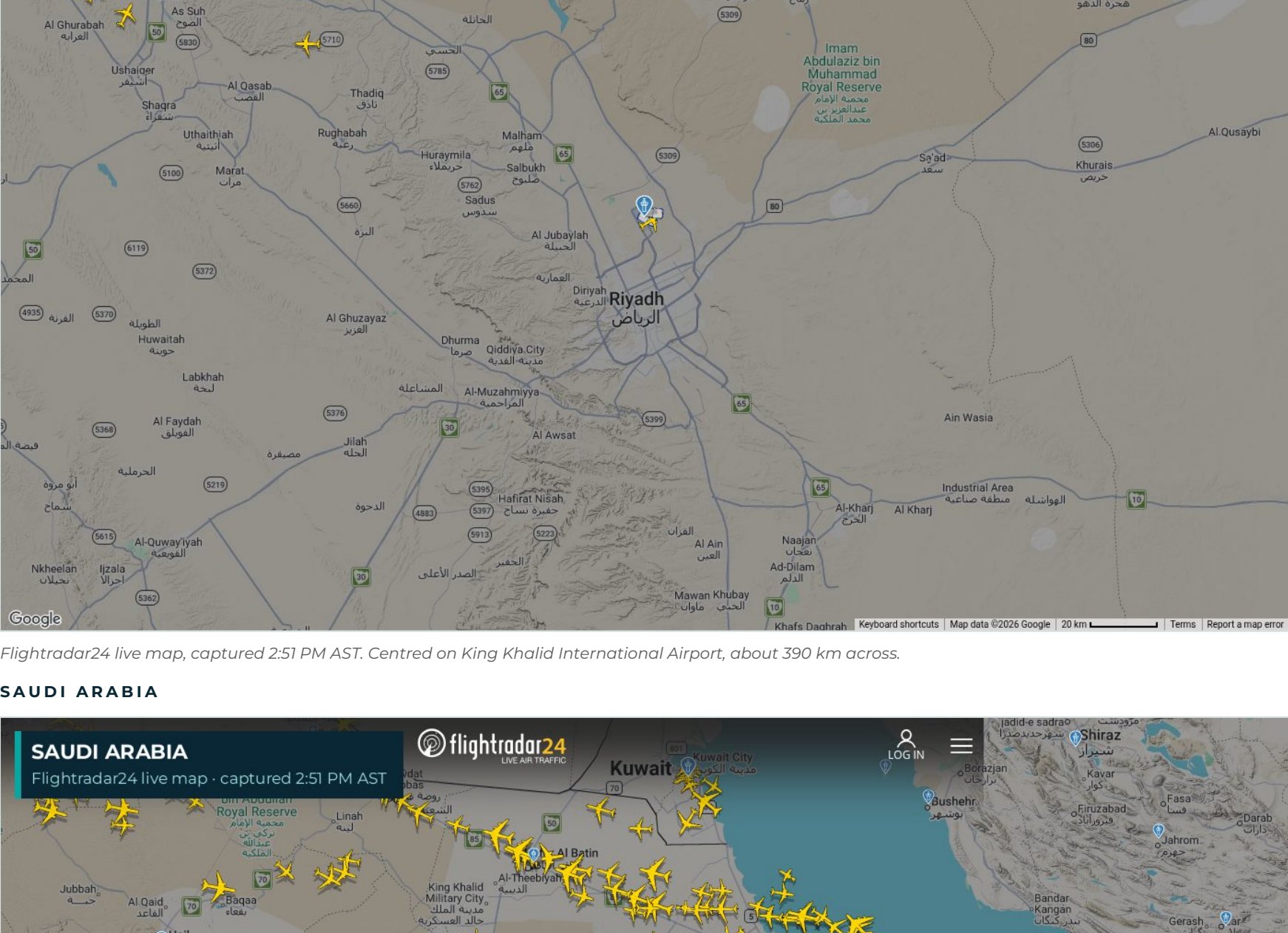
Source: Flightradar24 public airport data (airport.json details/stats panel, fetched 2:52 PM; departures and arrivals boards, fetched 2:51 PM). Rankings count both directions from the board for today. The stats panel and the board count slightly differently, so a few flights' difference is expected. Outbound diversions are not shown on the RUH board.

## 1 Takeoffs and landings per hour, last 24 hours to 2:51 PM.



Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window (clipped at the left edge): yesterday 1:58–3:14 PM, 4:05–4:50 PM, 7:41–9:38 PM, overnight 1:18–2:20 AM; this morning 6:37–8:08 AM, and the open afternoon halt since 2:05 PM.

## 2 Live traffic picture over Riyadh and the region.



**Read with care:** the maps show only aircraft that Flightradar24 tracks (ADS-B and similar feeds). Military, some state and transponder-off flights do not appear, and positions can lag by up to a minute. Yellow icons are aircraft; blue pins are airports.

## 3 Next departures from RUH: 2 of 5 routes on schedule.

| ROUTE           | FLIGHT | AIRLINE        | SCHEDULED | ESTIMATE | STATUS OF LISTED FLIGHT | CANCELLED |
|-----------------|--------|----------------|-----------|----------|-------------------------|-----------|
| Dubai (DXB)     | SV554  | Saudia         | 1:45 PM   | 2:30 PM  | Has not left yet        | 8         |
| Bahrain (BAH)   | SV520  | Saudia         | 3:25 PM   | 3:25 PM  | On schedule             | 0         |
| Muscat (MCT)    | WY684  | Oman Air       | 4:05 PM   | 4:05 PM  | On schedule             | 2         |
| Abu Dhabi (AUH) | EY556  | Etihad Airways | 4:45 PM   | 5:00 PM  | Delayed                 | 1         |
| Doha (DOH)      | QR8731 | Qatar Airways  | 11:45 AM  | —        | Has not left yet        | 5         |

Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures board, fetched 2:51 PM. Cancelled = today's cancelled departures on the route. Status describes the listed flight itself: on schedule = no later estimate; delayed = estimate 15+ minutes after schedule. Dubai includes DXB only. Riyadh Air RX243 to Dubai, due 3:50 PM, finally left at 9:50 PM. Cancelled today include Emirates EK816, EK820, EK818, flydubai FZ848, FZ842, FZ856 and flynas XY217 to Dubai; Qatar Airways QR1167, QR1171, QR1241, QR1169, QR1165, QR1239 and QR1173 to Doha; Etihad EY552, EY556 and EY560 to Abu Dhabi; SalamAir OV206 to Muscat.

## 4 Airport halted since 2:05 PM (45+ min, no takeoff or landing); Air Arabia suspends Sharjah–Riyadh through Sunday; SriLankan still suspended to 18 Oct; UAE carriers still cutting Saturday; GACA silent on today's stops.

Checked at 2:55 PM: Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED Air Arabia suspends Sharjah–Riyadh, Tabuk and Abha flights through Sunday

Gulf Today · 1:45 PM · published / last updated ~1:45 PM AST (Gulf Today 10 Oct); last checked 2:55 PM

Gulf Today reports Air Arabia has temporarily suspended Sharjah–Riyadh flights G9151 and G9154 on Saturday and Sunday (10–11 October), plus Tabuk G9634 on 11 October and Abu Dhabi–Abha G9195 on both days, with services expected to resume Monday 12 October pending further changes. The same report notes Emirates, Etihad and flydubai suspensions through 11 October. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED SriLankan Airlines suspends all Riyadh flights until 18 October

Aviation Voice / The Morning / Newswire · 12:20 PM · published ~12:20–12:45 PM AST (Aviation Voice / The Morning / Newswire 10 Oct); last checked 2:55 PM

Aviation Voice, The Morning and Newswire report SriLankan Airlines has temporarily suspended all flights to Riyadh until 18 October 2026 after the security incident at King Khalid airport, citing ongoing safety and operational assessments. The airline said services will resume once conditions are considered suitable. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED UAE Vartha: Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia cancel UAE–Riyadh services Saturday

UAE Vartha · 11:00 AM · published 10 Oct 2026 (UAE Vartha); last checked 2:55 PM

UAE Vartha reports Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia cancelled multiple UAE–Riyadh services on Saturday, citing operational disruption at King Khalid airport, with spillover cancellations to Abha and Yanbu. Etihad grounded EY551/EY555 and EY552/EY556 while keeping EY559/EY560; Emirates cancelled EK815/EK819 and EK816/EK818/EK820; flydubai scrubbed FZ847/FZ841/FZ855 and FZ848/FZ842/FZ856; Air Arabia cancelled Sharjah–Riyadh and Abha rotations. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED Gulf News: Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia still cutting UAE–Riyadh on Saturday

Gulf News · 9:21 AM · published 9:21 AM AST (Gulf News 10:21 AM GST); last checked 2:55 PM

Gulf News reports travellers between the UAE and Riyadh still face cancellations on Saturday from Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia. flydubai lists Riyadh and Yanbu cancellations through 10 October and Abha through 11 October; Etihad cites operational disruption at Riyadh airport. Flightradar24 board figures in this edition are the live totals.

CONFIRMED Anadolu / Alekhbariya: passenger flow at RUH described as smooth after Thursday attacks

Anadolu Agency / News.az · 10:10 AM · published ~10:10 AM (News.az / Anadolu dated 10 Oct); last checked 12:55 PM

Anadolu Agency, citing Saudi state TV Alekhbariya, says passenger movement at King Khalid airport was flowing smoothly and air traffic returned to normal on Friday after the Thursday attacks that killed three Saudi citizens. GACA had said operations resumed Friday. This edition's board still shows elevated Saturday cancellations and airline suspensions; no official comment on this morning's 6:37–8:08 AM halt.

CONFIRMED PIA suspends Riyadh flights; Lufthansa, Etihad and flydubai cuts continue

Dawn · 4:43 AM · published 4:43 AM (Dawn updated); last checked 12:55 PM

Dawn reports Pakistan International Airlines temporarily suspended flights to Riyadh, citing the Middle East situation. The same roundup notes Lufthansa Group suspended Riyadh services until 16 October, Etihad cancelled further Abu Dhabi–Riyadh flights into Saturday, and flydubai cancelled Riyadh and Yanbu through 10 October. Flightradar24 figures cited there are earlier; see this edition's board totals for today.

UNVERIFIED Social posts claim a Ugandan national was killed in a Houthi missile attack at Riyadh airport

Unverified accounts on X · 7:45 AM · published ~7:45 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

Accounts on X name Ugandan bus driver Muwenda Edward as killed in a Houthi missile attack at Riyadh airport. GACA's confirmed fatality count remains three Saudi citizens from the 8 October attacks; no official confirmation of this additional name as of this check.

CONFIRMED Arab News Japan: widespread condemnation of Houthi attacks on King Khalid airport

Arab News Japan on X · 10:30 AM · published 10:30 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

Arab News Japan's strong and widespread condemnation on Friday of the Houthi attacks targeting King Khalid airport, with statements reiterating solidarity with the Kingdom. No new RUH operational figures in the post.

CONFIRMED Saudi Gazette: coalition destroyed 136 Houthi military targets

Saudi Gazette on X · 5:35 AM · published 5:35 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

Saudi Gazette reports the coalition announced a large-scale operation against the Houthis, destroying 136 military targets in areas under the group's control. No RUH operational information or morning airport disruption.

CONFIRMED UAE Foreign Ministry condemns Houthi attacks on King Khalid airport and Saudia aircraft

UAE MoFA / Khaleej Times · 10:06 AM · MoFA statement circulated overnight; Khaleej Times post ~10:06 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

UAE Ministry of Foreign Affairs strongly condemned Houthi attacks on King Khalid International Airport and a Saudia aircraft. Khaleej Times and the UAE Embassy in KSA amplified the statement. No RUH operational information.

## 5 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Board figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, Gulf routes, chart) come from the Flightradar24 RUH boards fetched at 2:51 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or Riyadh Airports feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- The headline cancellation figure is the board count; Flightradar24's stats panel lags it by a few flights. Delayed, on-time, average-delay and index figures are the panel's own.
- Reports consistent with: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent confirmations with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or direct reports not corroborated officially. Claims are attributed to their source.